

Podcast Boundary Language: How to Say No With Confidence (and Without Guilt).

Episode Title:

From Yes to Stress: A Lesson in Boundary Language

0:00–1:00 — Hook

Have you ever said “yes” to help a coworker, only to end up drowning in work you didn’t expect?

It started with good intentions. You wanted to be supportive, to be a team player. But somehow, that one favour turned into a full-on responsibility.

In this episode, I share what happened when I agreed to help with a teammate’s tasks without setting clear limits—and how that quiet “yes” became a loud problem.

1:00–6:00 — First-Person Story

We were in the middle of a busy season, and I was already juggling a full workload. One of my teammates, who manages our social media, reached out and said she was overwhelmed. She had lots going on in her personal life lately, and she just couldn’t keep up.

She asked if I could help.

I knew I didn’t really have the time. But I felt for her. So I said, “Sure, I can help.”

The thing is, I never clarified what “help” meant. I didn’t talk about my capacity or how much time I actually had. And because I didn’t set those boundaries, she assumed I’d be taking on all of the social media work.

Suddenly, it was all landing on me. I felt flustered and behind, trying to come up with something meaningful to post every day on top of my regular responsibilities. I started to dread it.

But the worst part? Other team members began sending me reel ideas and video clips like I was the new social media lead. It had quietly become my role, without a conversation.

I kept thinking, “Well, I did agree...” So I blamed myself and kept going. But inside, I was frustrated. The work didn’t feel sustainable or fair.

That’s when I realized something needed to change. I didn’t just need help managing my workload, I needed to be more honest about it from the beginning.

6:00–8:00 — Reflection

What I learned is this: saying yes when you mean no doesn’t help your team. It hides problems.

It’s easy to think that saying no is rude or unprofessional, but in reality, clear boundaries are a sign of respect.

When we say no with honesty and kindness, we make space for real collaboration, and we protect the quality of our work.

8:00–11:00 — Alternatives + Tools

Looking back, the problem wasn't just that I said yes. It was *how* I said yes, without context, limits, or clarity. I wanted to help, but I didn't explain what I could realistically take on. And that created confusion for me, my teammate, and eventually, the whole team.

Here's what I could have done differently—and what you can try, too:

1. Use a “Yes, but” response to set limits.

Instead of a full yes, try:

“I can help with one post this week, but I won't be able to take on the full calendar.”

This kind of response shows willingness *and* defines boundaries.

2. Offer clarity with timeframes.

Saying when and how you can help reduces assumptions. For example:

“I'm able to help this week, but after Friday, I'll need to pass it back.”

This helps others plan and protects your time.

3. Invite shared ownership.

If it feels like the task is being offloaded completely, bring it back to collaboration:

“Happy to support you with this, but let's decide who's leading and what I'm just helping with.”

That small shift keeps the lines of responsibility clear.

Saying no—or even saying *yes with limits*—isn't about being unhelpful. It's about being honest, so your support is sustainable.

11:00–12:00 — Closing Takeaway

Here's what I want you to remember:

Saying no doesn't mean you're not a team player. It means you know your role, your limits, and your value.